

06/05/2025

DH Project and Data

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Updates

DH Minor / Certificate

Did you know that you can apply for a **Digital Humanities Minor** or a **Certificate** for grad students?

The minor consists of two required courses and three elective courses, taught over two consecutive six-week summer sessions. Once the core courses are completed, any three electives will satisfy the minor requirements. The program can be completed in one summer or extended over multiple summers.

If you are enrolled in DIGHUM 100 and/or 101, you are already part of the way there!



Interested in More DH This Summer?

DigHum 150A - Digital Humanities and Archival Design - MTuWTh 3:00-5:00pm, Online

This course combines research with digital design to create public-facing cultural heritage projects. Students will work with real archival materials from museums or choose their own. Final projects involve building interactive digital exhibits.

DigHum 150C - Digital Humanities and Textual and Language Analysis - MTuWTh 12:00-2:00pm, Online.

An introduction to computational literary analysis using Python—no coding background required. Learn to analyze texts through techniques like stylometry, topic modeling, and word embeddings. Designed for students interested in how computation can support interpretation across literary and informal language. Elective Course

DigHum 150B - Digital Humanities and Visual and Spatial Analysis - MTuWTh 9:30-11:30am, Online

Explore how digital tools—like GIS, data visualization, and network theory—can illuminate humanities questions. This course focuses on social and spatial analysis through maps, correspondence networks, and interactive visuals. Emphasis is on hands-on work with geospatial data, literary correspondence, and visual storytelling.

DigHum 160 - Critical Digital Humanities - Asynchronous Instruction

This fully asynchronous course explores how AI and algorithmic tools shape knowledge and interpretation. Through hands-on analysis of Reddit posts using Python and Jupyter notebooks, students critically examine digital culture, bias, and meaning-making. No coding experience needed. Fulfills L&S Philosophy & Values breadth.

 Learn more and enroll:
summerdigitalhumanities.berkeley.edu/courses

Review

Last week, we talked about DH projects and looked at examples.

Useful links for finding DH projects:

- <https://reviewsindh.pubpub.org/>
- <https://aclanthology.org/>
- <https://www.nature.com/palcomms/>
- <https://paperswithcode.com/>
- <https://zenodo.org/>
- <https://www.digitalhumanities.org/dhq/>
- <https://eupublishing.com/loi/ijhac>
- <https://openhumanitiesdata.metajnl.com/>
- <https://academic.oup.com/dsh>
- <https://culturalanalytics.org/>
- <https://journalofdigitalhistory.org/>

We also got into breakout rooms based on our interests to find group project partners.

After the class, we created a discussion post on bCourses to continue the conversation. Please post there, if you haven't already

Don't worry! You still have time to find a project team. We will do breakout rooms this session, too.

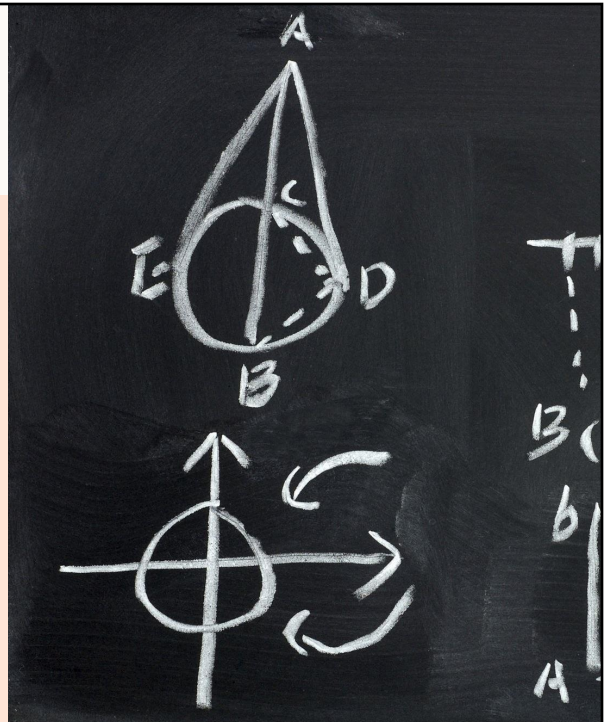
Next Assignment

Group Project - Topic Proposal Due: Friday, June 6

This assignment is **two-pages long**, ca. 500 words.

It should contain the following:

- Names of the group members (incl. their names as it appears on bCourses)
- Dataset A link to the dataset that you will be using in this assignment and a description of the dataset and why you chose it
- Initial ideas What are some of the first questions that come to your mind? What directions will you explore? Where will you begin your analysis?

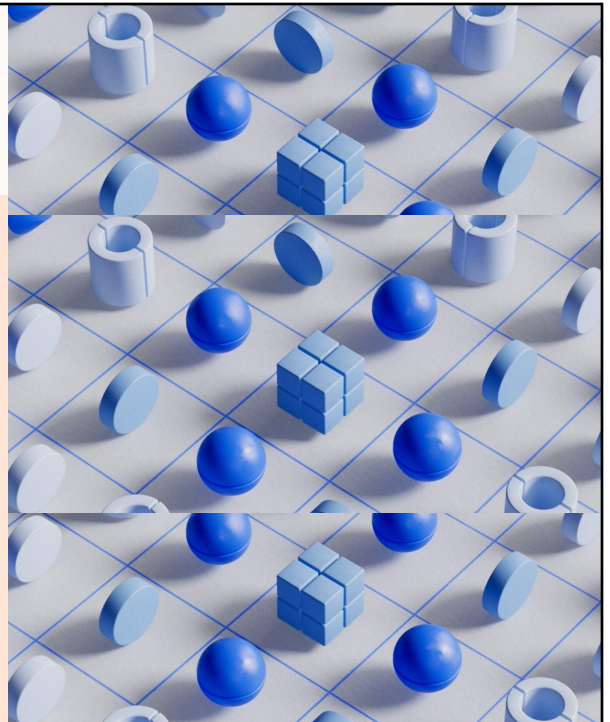


Datasets

What is Data?

The term 'data' comes from the plural of 'datum', a Latin word meaning 'something given.'

"Data is a **collection of facts, numbers, words, observations or other useful information**. Through data processing and data analysis, organizations transform raw data points into valuable insights"
(IBM 2024,
<https://www.ibm.com/think/topics/data>)



Let's complicate '*data*' (for DH)

Input: Artifact

An artifact is something that has been **created, shaped, or modified** by human beings and holds significance or meaning.

This line of argumentation could be expanded to natural phenomenon, events, and observations more generally but they are not our topic today.

Process: Quantification

Quantification is the process of transforming these artifacts into **measurable, categorized** units. It allows **numerical questions** and enables the analysis of these artifacts through a **unified, quantitative** framework.

We can think of letters as texts to be read and enjoyed or as collections of words to be counted.

Output: Data

Not everything becomes data and not everything that becomes data is valued in the same way.

Creating data involves **decisions** about what to count, measure, and categorize, shaping the data based on **societal and academic norms**.

A **dataset** refers to a structured collection of **quantified and categorized data**. Datasets contain data in various forms. They come in all shapes and sizes. Not all datasets have to be *'big.'* What matters is that your analysis and conclusions are in **proportion** to the kind of dataset that you studied.

Metadata refers to the **descriptive information about the dataset** itself, rather than the actual data it contains. Metadata provides contextual details that explain **how, where, and why the data was collected**, as well as the structure of the dataset. If the dataset includes any **annotations** (like themes, genre, period, etc.), metadata should describe **how the data was categorized or labeled**. It should also include the provenance or **the history of the data**, including any alterations or updates.

What to look for in a dataset?

A

What is in this dataset? Does it contain text files? Images? Spreadsheets? How many data points? What is/are the language(s) of the files? When were they created?

B

Who created this dataset and why? Are they clear about the decisions that went into the process of making this dataset?

C

How do you access this dataset? What are various rules and standards that govern the use of this dataset? How is this dataset shared?

D

What are some of use cases? What kind of research did the authors who published this dataset conducted with it?

Example: UNESCO's Proceedings, 1945–2017: A Bilingual Digital Text Corpus

The screenshot shows the article page for 'UNESCO's Proceedings, 1945–2017: A Bilingual Digital Text Corpus' in the Journal of Open Humanities Data. The page includes the journal logo, navigation buttons like 'Start Submission' and 'Become a Reviewer', and a 'Download' button. The article title is prominently displayed, followed by the authors: Benjamin G. Martin, Fredrik Mohammedi Norén, Roger Mähler, and Andreas Marklund, Oriane Martin. An abstract is provided, describing the corpus as a valuable resource for research in global humanities, containing metadata and supplementary material from 1946 to 2017. The abstract mentions that the corpus is stored on Zenodo and that relevant code is available on GitHub. It also notes that the corpus offers reuse potential for scholars and NLP developers. Keywords include 'digital text analysis', 'international organizations', 'transnational history', 'global humanities', 'text corpus', and 'corpus design'. The page also shows the volume (11), page/article number (31), and DOI (10.5334/johd.314). At the bottom, it indicates the submission date (Feb 5, 2025), acceptance date (Mar 26, 2025), and publication date (May 5, 2025), along with peer review and CC Attribution 4.0 information.

Journal of Open Humanities Data

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Reading: UNESCO's Proceedings, 1945–2017: A Bilingual Digital Text Corpus

[Download](#) [A+](#) [A-](#) [W](#) [AI Display](#)

Data Paper

UNESCO's Proceedings, 1945–2017: A Bilingual Digital Text Corpus

Benjamin G. Martin, Fredrik Mohammedi Norén, Roger Mähler, Andreas Marklund, Oriane Martin

Abstract

The record of the meetings of UNESCO's General Conference offers a valuable resource for research in the global humanities. We present a digital text corpus, including metadata and supplementary material, that makes the complete record of these meetings from 1946 to 2017 in English and/or French accessible in a machine-readable form that is suitable for digital text analysis. The corpus is stored on Zenodo; relevant code is available on GitHub. The corpus offers reuse potential for scholars interested in any of the countless issues that have been discussed and debated in UNESCO's General Conference over more than seventy years, as well as to Natural Language Processing (NLP) developers interested in the challenges of language recognition and automated segmentation.

Keywords: digital text analysis, international organizations, transnational history, global humanities, text corpus, corpus design

Year: 2025 Volume 11 Page/Article: 31 DOI: 10.5334/johd.314

Submitted on Feb 5, 2025 Accepted on Mar 26, 2025 Published on May 5, 2025

Peer Reviewed CC Attribution 4.0

Contents **Annotations & Comments** **Related Articles**

Abstract

(1) Overview (2) Method (3) Dataset Description (4) Reuse Potential

Notes Funding Statement Acknowledgements Competing Interests Author Contributions References

<https://openhumanitiesdata.metajnl.com/articles/10.5334/johd.314>

What is in this dataset?

A

This dataset contains **text files** in the form of **a bilingual digital text corpus**. The corpus includes the verbatim records from **UNESCO's General Conference Proceedings**, from 1946 to 2017, in **English and French**. The dataset has two corpora: one in English (approximately **15.7 million tokens**) and one in French (approximately **8.6 million tokens**), totaling around 21 million words. The corpus was compiled between February 2021 and December 2024.

Who created this dataset? Why? How?

B

The dataset was created by researchers in several Swedish universities, with Benjamin G. Martin from **Uppsala University** as the PI. The creation of the dataset was part of the **INIDUN project (International Ideas at UNESCO)**, which aimed to make UNESCO's General Conference Proceedings accessible for digital text analysis. The authors are clear about their decisions in the dataset creation process. **The OCR reprocessing and quality control steps are explained, detailing the procedures for checking OCR accuracy and improving the metadata.** They also describe the extraction process, the design of **scripts** for text extraction by language, and the approach for curating metadata.

How do you access this dataset?

C

The dataset is publicly available and can be accessed through the following links:

Zenodo: <https://zenodo.org/records/14786689>

GitHub repository: https://github.com/inidun/proceedings_curation/releases

The dataset is shared under the **Creative Commons Attribution 4.0 International (CC BY 4.0) license**, which allows users to **freely use, share, and adapt the data, as long as proper attribution is given to the creators.** There are no specific restrictions or rules mentioned beyond the attribution requirement, but users are encouraged to follow the project's code and documentation available on GitHub.

What are some use cases?

D

The dataset has **high reuse potential** for digital humanities and social sciences. It supports text analysis (e.g., word-trend analysis, topic modeling, word embeddings) to **study global debates at UNESCO's General Conference**. It also aids historical and transnational research on UNESCO's role in global discussions about **literacy, heritage, and communications**. Additionally, the corpus provides a rich resource for developing **Natural Language Processing (NLP) methods**, such as language recognition, segmentation, and OCR error correction. The authors used the dataset for research on **global conceptual history and international ideas at UNESCO**, enhancing interdisciplinary studies in global humanities.

GitHub Repository

Follow the link from the dataset paper:
https://github.com/inidun/proceedings_curation/releases

The screenshot shows the GitHub repository page for 'proceedings_curation' by user 'inidun'. The page is dark-themed and displays the 'Releases' section for version 'v1.0'. The release was made by 'albakeneko' on Nov 27, 2024, with 4 commits to main since the release. The release is labeled 'Latest' and has a 'Compare' button. Below the release information, there is a list of assets:

- meetings_eng.zip: Corpus consisting of English text extracted from UNESCO's Proceedings, 1945-2017. Contains 15.7M tokens. Uncompressed size: 83.9 MB.
- meetings_fre.zip: Corpus consisting of French text extracted from UNESCO's Proceedings, 1945-2017. Contains 8.6M tokens. Uncompressed size: 48.3 MB.
- meetings_eng_fre.zip: Corpus consisting of English and French text extracted from UNESCO's Proceedings, 1945-2017.
- Proceedings OCR Quality Control_Overview.xlsx: An overview of the OCR quality of the Proceedings PDFs.
- metadata_index.xlsx: An overview of all sessions and meetings (XLSX format).
- metadata_index.csv: An overview of all sessions and meetings (CSV format).

Tokens were counted using `nlTK.tokenize.word_tokenize`.

Below the assets list, there is a table showing the details of the assets:

Asset	Size	Created
meetings_eng.zip	30.2 MB	Nov 27, 2024
meetings_eng_fre.zip	47.4 MB	Dec 10, 2024
meetings_fre.zip	16.6 MB	Nov 27, 2024
metadata_index.csv	986 KB	Dec 10, 2024

UNESCO Proceedings

It is crucial to understand where the data is coming from

Records of the General Conference of UNESCO, second session, Mexico, 1947, v. 1: Proceedings,
<https://unesdoc.unesco.org/ark:/4822/3/pf0000214793.locale=en>

The CHAIRMAN : You have heard the motion, ladies and gentlemen. Any discussion ? Then we shall take the vote. All in favour kindly hold up their hands. Against ? The motion is carried.⁽¹⁾

M. MARITAIN (France) (*Translation from the French*) : I shall read the second part of Resolution IV :

(2) that Round Table Discussions dealing with topics proposed in the final resolution of the Round Table Discussions in Mexico be organized by Unesco in 1948, in conjunction with the Amsterdam International Congress of Philosophy;

(3) that Unesco make arrangements with a number of philosophical reviews, or general cultural reviews, of a high order and of international circulation, so that these may devote special issues to symposia dealing with these topics. A suitable number of copies of such issues would be distributed by Unesco in connexion with the Discussions referred to in No. 2.

The CHAIRMAN : The motion is seconded by the delegate of the United States. It is a little difficult for the meeting to discuss these matters. For instance, No. 2, Round Table Discussions, deals with « topics » but we do not know what those topics are.

These resolutions, i. e. Nos. 2 and 3 of Resolution IV, are now open for discussion. If there is no discussion, will all those in favour of the resolution kindly hold up their hands. Resolutions 2 and 3 are carried, consequently Resolution IV as a whole is carried.⁽²⁾

M. MARITAIN (France) (*Translation from the French*) : Mr. Chairman, with your permission we can now turn to Resolution V, reading :

The Working Party on Translations, in the light of the Report on Translations (Doc. 20/41) and its deliberations thereon, resolves as follows :

(1) In view of the importance of translations of classics of various countries for international understanding, Unesco will in 1948 put into effect the measures set forth in document 20/41 for the translation of classics.

(2) The Director-General is therefore instructed in accordance with the resolution of the Economic and Social Council : (a) in the light of the work of the Conference of Allied Ministers of Education, to take measures necessary for the preparation of a co-ordinated plan for the translation of classics, for submission to the Economic and Social Council by 4 June 1948, and keep the Council informed of progress of work on this project, seeking in turn all possible aid for the project from the United Nations Organization ;

(3) to prepare plans for ensuring adequate translation of : (a) the great works of classic reputation to which the Economic and Social Council refers ;

(b) contemporary works not only in the field of literature, but also in those of philosophy and of social and natural sciences, the diffusion of which is of extreme importance for international understanding ;

⁽¹⁾ In final form : Resolutions 2.3.3.4. ; vol. II, page 16 and 4.3.3.2. ; page 21.

⁽²⁾ In final form : Resolutions 4.3.1.1. ; vol. II, page 23 and 4.3.1.2. ; page 21.

(3) to summon an International Committee of Experts to review recommendations from Member States and other sources, and prepare the final list and proposals and to report : (d) To examine and seek means by which to assist smaller countries in their participation in this project.

(3) The General Conference recommends to Member States that, through their National Commissions, they set up such a Committee of Experts to prepare lists of literary, philosophical and scientific works with a view to eventual translation, and co-operate with Unesco through the various stages of the project.

The CHAIRMAN : Does anyone second this ? It is seconded by the delegate of the United States.

Does anyone wish to speak to it ? The delegate of Canada.

Mr. S. D. PIERCE (Canada) : I would like to make the same point that has been made before, where mention is made of National Commissions. The point is that not all countries have National Commissions, and therefore paragraph 3 should be amended to cover the case of countries which have no National Commissions.

It might be amended by saying « through their National Commissions where they exist », or using the words which we used on another occasion, « that, where possible, through their National Commissions. . . »

The CHAIRMAN : I take it the mover of the motion would have no objection to the words « where possible » being introduced into the second line of paragraph 3 ?

Is there anyone now who wishes to speak to this Resolution V ?

If not, I will put it to the vote. All in favour ? Against ?

The resolution is passed.⁽³⁾

While we are on this particular point I must now again give the opportunity to anyone else who wants to raise a matter concerned with Translation.

If there is none, we have finished the whole of that section on Translation in Chapter II.D.1. There is still « Language » in II.D.1., which has not yet been touched. The delegate of France.

M. MARITAIN (France) (*Translation from the French*) : Mr. Chairman, there is no other formal proposal arising from the discussions of the Working Party to submit as a resolution.

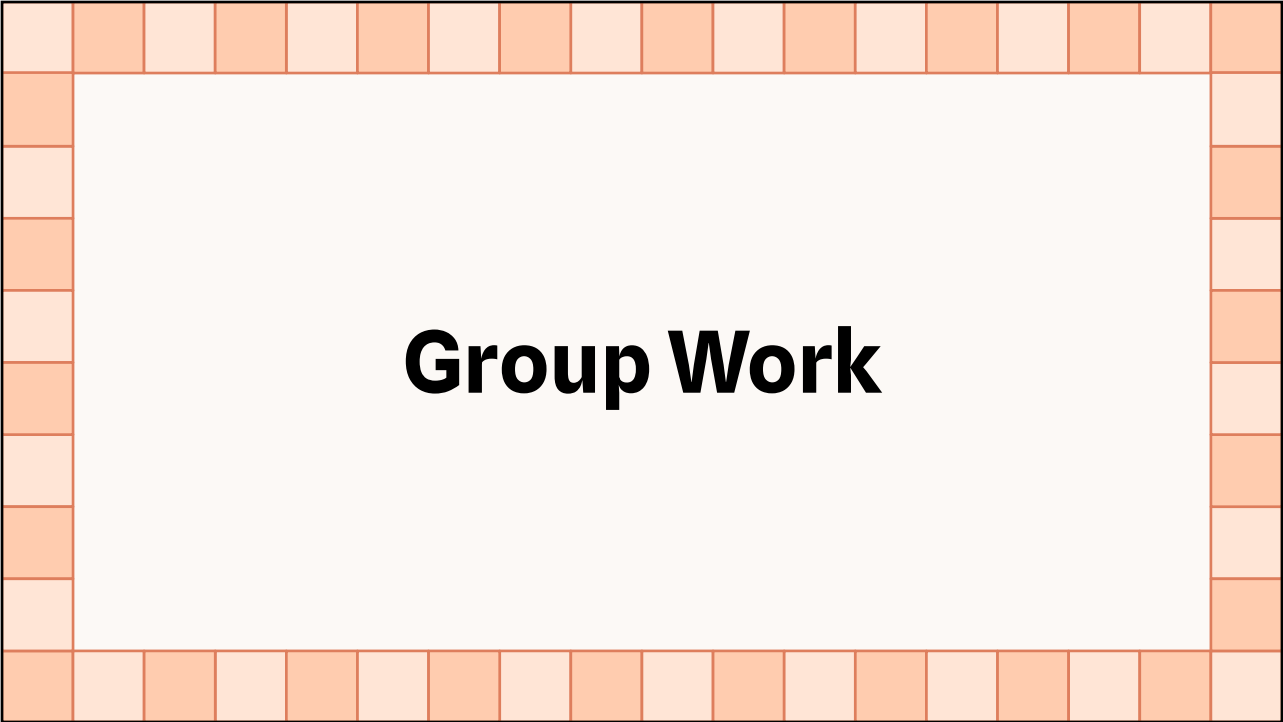
I only want to remark that there is a general motion, in the seventh part, page 11 of the English text, which approves as a whole a number of basic documents submitted by the Secretariat. I do not think, however, this need be submitted to the present Commission, since it was elaborated and drafted

⁽³⁾ In final form : Resolution 4.2. ; vol. II, page 23.

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Where to find more datasets?

- <http://dhresourcesforprojectbuilding.pbworks.com/w/page/69244469/Dta%20Collections%20and%20Datasets> (Alan Liu)
- <https://introdigitalstudies2024.common.msu.edu/datasets/> (Kristen Mapes)
- <https://www.kaggle.com/>
- <https://zenodo.org/>
- <https://www.hathitrust.org/> or <https://analytics.hathitrust.org/>
- <https://www.gutenberg.org/> (scraping needed)
- JSTOR Collections and Open Access Digital Humanities on Project MUSE also contain various collections of newspapers, historical journals, and others that can be turned into datasets (not for this class!)



Group Work